Access Control Policy

Document ID: NW-SEC-004 · Version 2.1 · Classification: Confidential

1. Purpose

This policy defines who may access Northwind Analytics information, how access is granted and reviewed, and how it is removed. It applies to all staff, contractors and service accounts that handle company or client data.

2. Principles

- Least privilege: people receive only the access their current role requires, and nothing more.
- Need to know: confidential documents are shared with named individuals, never with whole teams by default.
- Time-limited access: external shares expire automatically; the default is 7 days and the maximum is 30 days.
- Accountability: every grant, download and revocation is recorded in a tamper-evident audit log.

3. Roles

Role	May do	May not do
Administrator	Manage users, settings, audit	Read document contents
Operator	Upload, share, revoke	Change policy settings
Viewer	Open files shared with them	Upload or re-share

4. Granting access

Access to a confidential document is requested from its owner, who shares it with the named recipient for a stated period and, where appropriate, a maximum number of downloads. Every opened copy carries a watermark that identifies the recipient.

5. Review cycle

Owners review the active shares on their documents every quarter. Shares that are no longer needed are revoked. Administrators review role assignments every six months and after any change of team.

Review	Owner	Frequency
Active document shares	Document owner	Quarterly
User roles	Administrator	Every six months
Audit log integrity	Administrator	Monthly

6. Removing access

- When a person leaves, their account is disabled on their last working day.
- Shares that are no longer needed are revoked immediately; revocation takes effect on the next request.
- Revocation cannot recall copies already downloaded, so the watermark is used to trace any leak.

7. Incidents

Suspected misuse, a leaked document or a failed audit-log verification must be reported to the security team within 24 hours. Do not delete evidence: export the audit trail and keep the affected files.

8. Approval

Approved by: Head of Security (fictional) · Effective: 1 January 2026 · Next review: 1 January 2027